



Ascension Island

Dormant volcanoes

Location South Atlantic

Highest point 2,818 ft (859 m)

Last eruption 700 years ago

Ascension Island is a hotspot island near the Mid-Atlantic Ridge between Brazil and West Africa. It is only about 5 million years old—young by geological standards—and is not part of a hotspot chain, although it may be in the future. Its surface is peppered with volcanic craters such as the one shown here, but its volcanoes are dormant.

Galápagos

Mobile islands

Location East Pacific

Highest point 5,600 ft (1,707 m)

Last eruption 2009

Lying on the equator off the Pacific coast of South America, the Galápagos are a group of 21 volcanic islands and many smaller islets that have formed over a hotspot on the Pacific ocean floor. They are being carried east off the hotspot at the rate of 2.5 in (6.4 cm)

a year, and the oldest, most easterly volcanoes are now extinct and sinking. The youngest volcanoes on Fernandina and Isabela islands are still active, creating barren landscapes of dark basalt lava. The islands are also famous for their unique wildlife.

▼ FLOODED CRATER

The small islet of Rocas Baimbridgen off the east coast of San Salvador island is the tip of a submerged volcanic cone.



Easter Island

Triple peak

Location Southeast Pacific

Highest point 1,663 ft (507 m)

Last eruption 10,000 years ago

Formed from three volcanoes that have become joined together, Easter Island lies at the western end of a chain of seamounts extending 2,485 miles (4,000 km) east to South America. The chain was created by the ocean floor slipping west over a hotspot near Easter Island, but the volcanoes on the island itself are now extinct.



▲ STONE STATUES

Easter Island is famous for its many huge statues, carved centuries ago from rock cut from the slopes of one of its volcanoes.

